

HOW TO SAFEGUARD TOUCHSCREEN DEVICES

Here are a few best practices that can help you protect your touchscreen device and increase its life!

■ ANKIT TUTEJA

It won't be an exaggeration to say that Apple's iPhone has changed the way we perceive a mobile phone. It has ushered in the era of touchscreen devices.

Considering the ease-of-use that touchscreen devices offer, their adoption amongst gadget freaks as well as busy professionals is on the rise. Today, multiple types of touchscreen devices are available in the market, like mobile phones, tablet PCs, personal digital assistants (PDAs), LCD monitors, etc. The flip side is that such devices are not only expensive but fragile too. This makes it all the more important that you handle these delicate, prized possessions of yours with due care.

Given below are a few tips that on the one hand can help you maximise the performance of your touchscreen device and on the other hand, prolong its life.

Screen protector. Touchscreens are highly prone to damage. When these devices are put to use, they are inevitably exposed to different materials and surfaces. This can either lead to scratches on the screen or may damage some portions of the screen, thereby affecting its usability and performance. Therefore whenever you buy a touchscreen device, the first thing that you should do is get the display screen covered, end-to-end, with a high-quality screen guard. The screen guard can be acquired at any reliable mobile store at an affordable price. It is recommended that you buy the type that is removable, washable and also protects your



screen from ultraviolet rays.

It is important to ensure that while applying the screen protector, the screen is thoroughly cleaned, otherwise bubbles will appear where there are dust particles on the screen.

Cleaning. Touchscreen devices are very sensitive to dust particles, oil and grease. Therefore always use such devices with clean fingers and try to avoid using them in a dusty environment. Apart from this, touchscreen devices should be cleaned frequently. If left unclean, the dust will not only start becoming visible on the screen but may also affect the internal components of the device.

Also, never clean the screen with strong chemicals. It is advised to use standard glass cleaners. While cleaning, don't spray the solution directly on to the screen. Instead, spray the liquid on a soft cloth and then use that cloth gently across the screen. Before cleaning, switch off the device. Some

devices have a cleaning mode, so if that is available, ensure that feature is turned on as it turns-off the screen for the specific purpose of cleaning.

Maximise stylus usage. If your phone comes with a stylus, use it for prolonged operations so as to protect your screen from any stains resulting from oily or sweaty hands, as fingerprints and sweat can reduce the visibility of what's displayed on the screen.

Handle the stylus upright relative to the touchscreen and hold it the same way as you would hold your pen or pencil. Also, be gentle in operating the stylus. Since a touchscreen is sensitive to a light touch, apply moderate pressure to tap the screen.

A few more user-level best practices

1. Don't keep your touchscreen device in the back pocket of your trousers as it may damage the sensitive screen.
 2. Make sure that there are no hard objects like keys and coins in your pocket and bag. Any such item may cause scratches on the screen.
 3. Don't keep your touchscreen device exposed to direct sunlight, like on the dashboard of your car. Excessive heat can damage the screen.
 4. Always keep your touchscreen device in a cover with a soft lining to prevent it from getting scratched.
- So, keep the above mentioned practices in mind. These will not only ensure the longevity of your touchscreen device but also keep its performance well for a longer period of time. ●

The author is from EFY Bureau, New Delhi. The article has been reproduced from EFY's Bennett magazine